

Vasile Grafu

Engineering Manager | Solutions Architect | Enterprise & AI Systems

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SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 20+ years in software — from game programming at Ubisoft to cloud platforms handling millions of requests a day, now building agentic AI systems.

SKILLS

Leadership & Management: Engineering Management, Team & Technical Leadership, Hiring & Mentoring, Agile / Scrum, Project Management (Prince2), Strategic Planning

Backend & Architecture: C#, .NET, ASP.NET Core, Entity Framework, LINQ, Python, FastAPI, SQLAlchemy, Solution & Software Architecture, Framework Design, API Design & E-commerce Integrations

Frontend & Web: JavaScript, ReactJS, HTML, CSS, SASS, Material UI, Astro, Tailwind CSS

AI & Machine Learning: AI-Assisted Software Development, Agentic Architectures & LLM Orchestration, RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation), Prompt Engineering & MCP-style Tool Integration, Machine Learning & Deep Learning (TensorFlow, NumPy, Pandas), Neural Networks & Reinforcement Learning

Cloud, Data & DevOps: AWS (EC2, ECS, RDS, S3, CloudFormation), Docker, CI/CD, SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Database Design, Relational Databases

Foundations: Probability, Linear Algebra, Calculus, Statistics, Data Structures & Algorithms, Problem Solving & Analytical Thinking, Software Architecture Principles, Design Patterns & Clean Code

EXPERIENCE

Engineering Manager · nShift (formerly Consignor), Bucharest, Romania

January 2022 – Present

nShift is a global leader in parcel delivery management and multi-carrier shipping software. I lead the Webservices Team — one of the company's core teams — building web services that handle millions of requests per day and support multiple business-critical applications. I combine hands-on development with leadership: contributing to coding, architecture, and decision-making while ensuring alignment across teams.

- Lead and manage the Webservices Team: setting clear goals, providing direction, and keeping every member motivated and effective.
- Establish engineering processes and standards — consistent development practices that improve collaboration, maintain quality, and accelerate delivery.
- Recruit and develop engineers: active role in hiring, onboarding, and mentoring to build a skilled, cohesive team.
- Provide technical guidance: solving complex issues alongside developers, reviewing designs, and making critical decisions on challenging topics.
- Contribute to software architecture: design and implementation of scalable, secure, and maintainable systems.
- Hands-on development: shared components, application structure, data flow, database design, security principles, and infrastructure improvements.
- Solution Architect for our applications: designing and managing cloud environments on AWS and implementing CI/CD pipelines.
- Act as Scrum Master: stand-ups, planning, retrospectives, and effective communication between Product Owners and developers.
- Building a large-scale internal conversational AI platform: LLMs, agent orchestration, RAG, and MCP-style tool integration.

AI-assisted development · C# / .NET / ASP.NET Core · Python / FastAPI / SQLAlchemy · SQL Server / PostgreSQL · AWS (EC2, ECS, RDS, S3) · Docker · JavaScript / ReactJS / Material UI

Team Manager · Consignor, Bucharest, Romania

January 2017 – January 2022

Consignor, a Scandinavian company with offices in Norway, Denmark, and Sweden, was the largest supplier of transport administration solutions in Scandinavia. I led two teams and wore the hat each situation demanded: Team Manager, Technical Lead, Project Manager (Prince2), or Software Developer.

- Webservices Team: ran the web services serving the client components of the Consignor business.
- Integration Team: brought Consignor functionality to the major e-commerce platforms.
- Hiring, training, and coordinating people; critical architecture decisions; hands-on development; and management of cross-team projects.

Technical Lead · Consignor, Bucharest, Romania

2009 – 2017

Led the team behind 50 web services and 5 full-stack web applications serving over 10,000 business clients in the Consignor application suite, distributed across Amazon Cloud.

- Key part of the entire application development workflow.
- Designed many modules of the business software to satisfy client requirements.
- Mentored junior and senior developers.
- Wrote detailed technical and user documentation.
- Acted as liaison between the development team and other departments.

C# .NET, ASP.NET MVC · WCF · SQL Server Enterprise · JavaScript, jQuery, Bootstrap, LESS/SASS · Python, IronPython · Amazon Web Services

Team Leader · TeamNet, Bucharest, Romania

2008 – 2009

TeamNet offered software development and implementation services for the business segment of the market.

- Managed the Optimus ERP modules through all development steps, from specification to testing and deployment.
- Elaborated development plans for new features in collaboration with the design department.
- Responsible for enhancing existing features and for triaging and resolving all defects identified by the Quality Department.

Game Programmer · Ubisoft, Bucharest, Romania

January 2005 – June 2008

Ubisoft is one of the leading game publishers worldwide. I designed, developed, and optimized gameplay and platform modules on four shipped and in-development titles.

- Silent Hunter 4: designed and built the framework managing the evolution of the Crew, Weapons, and Equipment of the U-Boat simulator, plus the Career module.
- King Kong (PC): Intel Viiv / Windows Media Center integration, multithreaded rendering, and the security module.
- Blazing Angels (PC): Save/Load system and Media Center shell implementation.
- Tom Clancy's FireHawk: ERS (Enhanced Reality System) module.

C++, STL · Software optimization · Linear algebra, calculus, probabilities

KEY PROJECT

Internal Conversational AI Platform

Engineering Manager & Architect · nShift

A large-scale internal AI assistant built on an agentic architecture: LLMs combined with orchestration layers, RAG, and structured prompt engineering. Domain-specific agents for different departments — each with tailored prompts, tools, and data access — collaborate through an orchestration layer. A continuous ingestion pipeline indexes internal documentation, APIs, and business data into knowledge stores, so responses stay context-aware and grounded in company-specific information.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Science, Specialization in Project Management — Academy of Economic Studies, Bucharest (2000 – 2002)

Bachelor in Business Administration, Major in Computer Science, Specialization in Computer Science Applied in Business — Academy of Economic Studies, Bucharest (1995 – 2000)

SELF-LEARNING

I have a deeply curiosity-driven mindset that consistently pushes me beyond the boundaries of formal job requirements. I genuinely enjoy understanding how things work at a fundamental level, and this has led me to independently build a strong conceptual foundation across computer science and AI. Over time, I have studied machine learning, deep learning, neural networks, reinforcement learning, probability theory, linear algebra, calculus, and statistics — not simply to become familiar with these topics, but to understand the principles and mathematics that make them work.

I place particular value on developing strong intuition for what happens under the hood. Rather than treating algorithms and models as black boxes, I try to understand their underlying mechanisms, assumptions, limitations, and trade-offs. This way of thinking allows me to reason more effectively about system design, model behavior, and complex technical problems, even when working outside areas I have encountered before.